consider the treaty “in the light of cold reason and self-interest.” The US was too distant and could give India “little comfort in such a situation.” Furthermore, India needed to consider the possibility that Indian “dilly-dally[ing]” would result in the Soviet Union’s signing “a Pact of perpetual peace and non-aggression with Pakistan.”[52]

Concerns about the Soviet-Pakistan relationship—and the resultant doubts about Soviet reliability—on the other hand also played into Indian hesitation about the treaty. Moscow’s attempt at a “new look” relationship with Pakistan had enhanced concerns about its dependability.[53] Indian officials repeatedly warned Soviet counterparts about equating India and Pakistan and about aiding Pakistan militarily. Kosygin tried to play down the level and kind of assistance. He used the same justification that Indian policymakers had heard from Washington—that it was in India’s interest that the Soviet Union supply Pakistan lest the latter become too dependent on other sources.[54] Questions about Soviet reliability persisted in India, however, further fueled by concerns about whether the Soviet attitude toward China would change.[55] Indians inside and outside government also noticed that Moscow had still not recognized Indian border claims vis-à-vis China.[56]

Along with concern about Soviet reliability and China’s reaction, Gandhi’s reluctance about the treaty also stemmed from domestic factors. Her political position was vulnerable, and she knew she would need to “carry the Parliament and the country.”[57] A treaty would be seen as India moving away from nonalignment, which remained popular. In spring 1968, 91 percent of 100 Indian parliamentarians surveyed had expressed a strong preference for India staying as neutral as possible.[58] Furthermore, the US still had a higher favorability rating (73 percent) than the Soviet Union (61 percent) with the Indian public.[59]

Gandhi and Dinesh Singh also worried about the impact of such a treaty on US-India relations. Despite his enthusiasm for the treaty, Haksar had pointed out the need to factor in its global impact. Beijing, which would see it as anti-China, might react unpredictably. To address any American concerns, he subsequently suggested that India could “offer the same to the rest of the world, including the USA.”[60]

Finally, despite a leftward turn by Gandhi in terms of domestic politics and policies, key members of her government remained wary of too much